

अथ द्वादशोऽध्यायः ॥

देव्युवाच ॥ १ ॥

एभिः स्तवैश्च मां नित्यं स्तोष्यते यः समाहितः ।
तस्याहं सकलां बाधां नाशयिष्याम्यसंशयम् ॥ २ ॥

मधुकैटभनाशं च महिषासुरघातनम् ।
कीर्तयिष्यन्ति ये तद्वद्वधं शुम्भनिशुम्भयोः ॥ ३ ॥

अष्टम्यां च चतुर्दश्यां नवम्यां चैकचैतसः ।
श्रोष्यन्ति चैव ये भक्त्या मम माहात्म्यमुत्तमम् ॥ ४ ॥

1-2. The Devi said: 'And whoever with a concentrated mind shall pray to me constantly with these hymns, I shall without doubt put down every trouble of his.

3. 'And those who shall laud (the story of) the destruction of Madhu and Kaitabha, the slaughter of Mahiṣāsura and the slaying of S'umbha and Nisumbha likewise.

4-5. 'And those also who shall listen with devotion to this sublime poem on my greatness on the eighth, the fourteenth and on the ninth days of the fortnight

न तेषां दुष्कृतं किञ्चिदुष्कृतोत्था न चापदः ।

भविष्यति न दारिद्र्यं न चैवेष्टत्रियौजनम् ॥ ५ ॥

शत्रुतो न भयं तस्य दस्युतो वा न राजतः ।

न शस्त्रानलतोयौघात् कदाचित् सम्भविष्यति ॥ ६ ॥

तस्मान्ममैतन्माहात्म्यं पठितव्यं समाहितैः ।

श्रोतव्यं च सदा भक्त्या परं स्वस्त्ययनं हि तत् ॥ ७ ॥

उपसर्गानशेषांस्तु महामारीसमुद्भवान् ।

तथा त्रिविधमुत्पातं माहात्म्यं शमयेन्मम ॥ ८ ॥

with concentrated mind, to them nothing wrong shall happen, nor calamities that arise from wrong doings, nor poverty and never separation from beloved ones.

6. 'He shall not experience fear from enemies, and nor from robbers and kings, nor from weapon, fire or flood.

7. 'Hence this poem of my greatness must be chanted by men of concentrated minds and listened to always with devotion; for it is the supreme course of well-being.

8. 'May this poem of my glories quell all epidemic calamities, as also the threefold natural calamities.

यत्रैतत्पठ्यते सम्यङ्ङित्यमायतने मम ।

सदा न तद्विमोक्षयामि सान्निध्यं तत्र मे स्थितम् ॥ ९ ॥

बलिप्रदाने पूजायामग्निकार्ये बहोत्सवे ।

सर्वं ममैतच्चरितमुच्चार्य श्राव्यमेव च ॥ १० ॥

जानताजानता वापि बलिभूजां तथा कृताम् ।

प्रतीच्छिष्याम्यहं प्रीत्या बहिर्दोमं तथाकृतम् ॥ ११ ॥

शरत्काले महापूजा क्रियते या च वार्षिकी ।

तस्यां ममैतन्माहात्म्यं श्रुत्वा भक्तिसमन्वितः ॥ १२ ॥

9. 'The place of my sanctuary where this poem is duly chanted everyday, I will never forsake and there my presence is certain.

10. 'When sacrifice is offered, during worship, in the fire-ceremony, and at a great festival, all this poem on my acts must be chanted and heard.

11. 'I will accept with love the sacrifice and worship that are made and the fire-offering that is offered likewise, whether they are done with due knowledge (of sacrifice) or not.

12-13. 'During autumnal season, when the great annual worship is performed, the man hearing this glorification of mine with devotion shall certainly

सर्वाबाधाविनिर्मुक्तो धनधान्यसुतान्वितः ।
मनुष्यो मत्प्रसादेन भविष्यति न संशयः ॥ १३ ॥

श्रुत्वा ममैतन्माहात्म्यं तथा चोत्पत्तयः शुभाः ।
पराक्रमं च युद्धेषु जायते निर्भयः पुमान् ॥ १४ ॥

रिपवः संक्षयं यान्ति कल्याणं चोपपद्यते ।
नन्दते च कुलं पुंसां माहात्म्यं मम शृण्वताम् ॥ १५ ॥

शान्तिकमणि सर्वत्र तथा दुःस्वप्नदर्शने ।
ग्रहपीडासु चोग्रासु माहात्म्यं शृणुयान्मम ॥ १६ ॥

through my grace, be delivered without doubt from all troubles and be blessed with riches, grains and children.

14. 'Hearing this glorification and auspicious appearances of mine, and my feats of prowess in battles, a man becomes fearless.

15. 'Enemies perish, welfare accrues and the family rejoices for those who listen to this glorification of mine.

16. 'Let one listen to this glorification of mine everywhere, at a propitiatory ceremony, on seeing a bad dream, and when there is the great evil influence of planets.

उपसर्गाः शमं यान्ति ग्रहपीडाश्च दारुणाः ।
दुःस्वप्नं च नृभिर्दृष्टं सुस्वप्नमुपजायते ॥ १७ ॥

बालग्रहाभिभूतानां बालानां शान्तिकारकम् ।
सङ्घातभेदे च वृणां मैत्रीकरणमुत्तमम् ॥ १८ ॥

दुर्वृत्तानामशेषाणां बलहानिकरं परम् ।
रक्षोभूतपिशाचानां पठनादेव नाशनम् ॥ १९ ॥

सर्वं ममैतन्माहात्म्यं मम सन्निधिकारकम् ।
पशुपुष्पाव्यधूपैश्च गन्धदीपैस्तथोत्तमैः ॥ २० ॥

17. ' (By that means) evil protents subside, as also the unfavourable influence of planets, and the bad dream seen by men turns into a good dream.

18. 'It creates peacefulness in children possessed by the seizes of children (i.e., evil spirits), and it is the best promoter of friendship among men when split occurs in their union.

19. 'It diminishes most effectively the power of all men of evil ways. Verily demons, goblins, and ogres are destroyed by its mere chanting.

20-30. 'This entire glorification of mine draws (a devotee) very near to me. And by means of finest cattle, flowers, arghya and incenses, and by perfumes and lamps, by feeding Brāhmaṇas, by oblations,

विप्राणां भोजनैर्होमैः प्रोक्षणीयैरहर्निशम् ।
अन्यैश्च विविधैर्भोगैः प्रदानैर्वत्सरेण या ॥ २१ ॥

प्रीतिर्मे क्रियते सास्मिन्सकृत्सुचरिते श्रुते ।
श्रुतं हरति पापानि तथारोग्यं प्रयच्छति ॥ २२ ॥

रक्षां करोति भूतेभ्यो जन्मनां कीर्तनं मम ।
युद्धेषु चरितं यन्मे दुष्टदैत्यनिबर्हणम् ॥ २३ ॥

तस्मिञ्छ्रुते वैरिकृतं भयं पुंसां न जायते ।
युष्माभिः स्तुतयो याश्च याश्च ब्रह्मर्षिभिः कृताः ॥ २४ ॥

by sprinkling (consecrated) water, and by various other offerings and gifts (if one worships) day and night in a year—the gratification, which is done to me, is attained by listening but once to this holy story of mine. The chanting and hearing of the story of my manifestations remove sins, and grant perfect health and protect one from evil spirits; and when my martial exploit in the form of the slaughter of the wicked daityas is listened to, men will have no fear from enemies. And the hymns uttered by you, and those by the divine sages, and those by Brahmā bestow a pious mind. He who is (lost) on a lonesome spot in a forest, or is surrounded by forest fire, or who

ब्रह्मणा च कृतास्तास्तु प्रयच्छन्ति शुभां मतिम् ।
अरण्ये प्रान्तरे वापि दावाश्विपरिवारितः ॥ २५ ॥

दस्युभिर्वा वृतः शून्ये गृहीतो वापि शत्रुभिः ।
सिंहव्याघ्रानुयातो वा वने वा वनहस्तिभिः ॥ २६ ॥

राज्ञा क्रुद्धेन चाज्ञप्तो बध्यो बन्धगतोऽपि वा ।
आघूर्णितो वा वातेन स्थितः पोते महावने ॥ २७ ॥

पतत्सु चापि शस्त्रेषु सङ्गमे भृशदारुणे ।
सर्वाबाधासु घोरानु वेदनाभ्यर्दितोऽपि वा ॥ २८ ॥

स्मरन् ममैतच्चरितं नरो मुच्येत सङ्कटात् ।
मम प्रभावात्सिंहाद्याः दस्यवो वैरिणस्तथा ॥ २९ ॥

दूरादेव पलायन्ते स्मरतश्चरितं मम ॥ ३० ॥

is surrounded by robbers in a desolate spot, or who is captured by enemies, or who is pursued by a lion, or tiger, or by wild elephants in a forest, or who under the orders of wrathful king is sentenced to death, or has been imprisoned, or who is tossed about in his boat by a tempest in the vast sea, or who is in the most terrible battle under shower of weapons, or who is amidst all kinds of dreadful troubles, or who is afflicted with pain—such a man on remembering this story of mine is saved from his strait. Through my power, lions etc., robbers and enemies, flee from a distance from him who remembers this story of mine’.

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ३१ ॥

इत्युक्त्वा सा भगवती चण्डिका चण्डविक्रमा ।

पश्यतामेव देवानां तत्रैवान्तरधीयत ॥ ३२ ॥

तेऽपि देवा निरातङ्गाः स्वाधिकारान्यथा पुरा ।

यज्ञभागभुजः सर्वे चक्रुर्विनिहतारयः ॥ ३३ ॥

दैत्याश्च देव्या निहते शुम्भे देवरिपौ युधि ।

जगद्विध्वंसिनि तस्मिन् महोग्रेऽतुलविक्रमे ॥ ३४ ॥

निशुम्भे च महावीर्ये शेषाः पातालमाययुः ॥ ३५ ॥

31-32. The Ṛṣi said: Having spoken thus the adorable Caṇḍikā, fierce in prowess, vanished on that very spot even as the devas were gazing on. .

33. Their foes having been killed, all the devas also were delivered from fear; all of them resumed their own duties as before and participated in their shares of sacrifices.

34-35. When the exceedingly valourous Śumbha and Nisumbha, the most fierce foes of devas, who brought ruin on the world, and who were unparalleled in prowess had been slain by the Devī in battle, the remaining daityas went away to Pātāla.

एवं भगवती देवी सा नित्यापि पुनः पुनः ।

सम्भूय कुरुते भूप जगतः परिपालनम् ॥ ३६ ॥

तयैतन्मोह्यते दिश्वं सैव दिश्वं प्रसूयते ।

सा याचिता च विज्ञानं तुष्टा ऋद्धिं प्रयच्छति ॥ ३७ ॥

व्याप्तं तयैतत्सकलं ब्रह्माण्डं सनुजेश्वर ।

महाकाल्या महाकाले महामारीस्वरूपया ॥ ३८ ॥

सैव काले महामारी सैव सृष्टिर्भवत्यजा ।

स्थितिं करोति भूतानां सैव काले सनातनी ॥ ३९ ॥

36. Thus O King, the adorable Devī, although eternal, incarnating again and again, protects the world.

37. By her this universe is deluded, and it is she who creates this universe. And when entreated, she bestows supreme knowledge, and when propitiated, she bestows prosperity.

38. By her, the Mahākālī, who takes the form of the great destroyer at the end of time, all this cosmic sphere is pervaded.

39. She indeed takes the form of the great destroyer at the (proper) time. She, the unborn, indeed becomes this creation (at the time proper for re-creation), She herself, the eternal Being, sustains the beings at (another) time.

भवकाले नृणां सैव लक्ष्मीर्वृद्धिप्रदा गृहे ।
सैवाभावे तथा लक्ष्मीर्विनाशायोपजायते ॥ ४० ॥

स्तुता सम्पूजिता पुष्पैर्धूपगन्धादिभिस्तथा ।
ददाति वित्तं पुत्रांश्च मतिं धर्मे गतिं शुभाम् ॥ ४१ ॥

इति श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
फलस्तुतिर्नाम द्वादशोऽध्यायः ॥ १२ ॥

40. In times of prosperity, she indeed is Lakṣmī, who bestows prosperity in the homes of men; and in times of misfortune, she herself becomes the goddess of misfortune, and brings about ruin.

41. When praised and worshipped with flowers, incense, perfumes, etc. she bestows wealth and sons, and a mind bent on righteousness and prosperous life.

Here ends the twelfth chapter called 'Eulogy of the Merits' of Devī-māhātmya in the Mār-kaṇḍeyapurāṇa, during the period of Sāvarni, the Manu.

